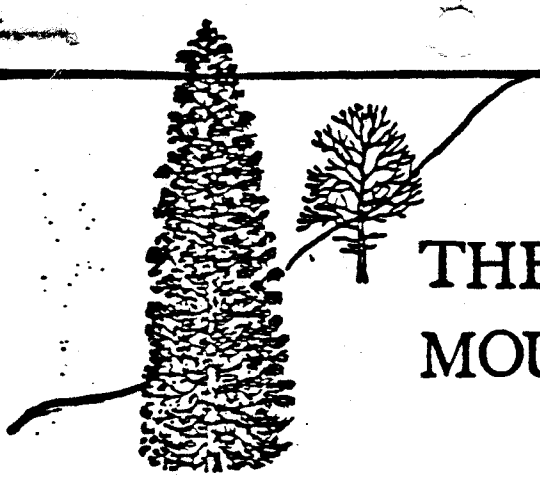


THE MOUNTAINSIDE NEWS

January 1992

Letter From the President . . .

. . . Jim Bradfield

1. On 19 November, there was a demonstration of the dry fire hydrant by a Berkeley Springs Fire Department pumper truck for the West Virginia Insurance Commissioner, representatives of the insurance industry, as well as fire department representatives from neighboring counties, arranged by Rebecca McLeod of the Soil Conservation office in Berkeley Springs. The purpose of the demonstration was to show that a dry fire hydrant, such as the one we provided to Morgan County, is an effective means for providing water in a rural setting without a city-type water distribution system. CMA will be working with the Berkeley Springs Fire Department to arrange for an insurance evaluation of the dry fire hydrant in connection with several pumper fire trucks in expanding the direct area of coverage for fighting a fire. Hopefully, this will result in lowering our fire insurance category.

2. On 16 December, on the advice of its lawyer, CMA exercised its private community position by closing off the entrance to CMA at the gatehouse and individually determining the necessary access of individuals and cars to the CMA area. We alerted Coolfont Recreation of this action so that they were able to arrange admission for guests who were occupying CMA homes.

3. A task force has been activated to study our water distribution system. Members of the task force, headed by Harry Birnkrant, will include Glen Bruels, Jim Groff, Neil Holtzman, Herb Jasper, Emmette Keese, and Leon Weinberger.

4. The sewer project has developed some problems that the Board and DACC are trying to resolve. Part of the problem has to do with leaks in the lagoons and additional unanticipated costs. Herb Jasper is enlisting the assistance of Jim Groff and Leon Weinberger to evaluate various alternatives to solve our sewage treatment problems.

5. The R reservoir has been put on line and the additional pressure has revealed more leaks in the distribution system that had not been detected earlier, due to the lower pressure provided by the North reservoir. We have been able to shut down the North reservoir, and we will clean out all the dirt and grime that has been accumulating for years when there is a reliable surplus of water. Raising the outtake valve within the reservoir will greatly assist in reducing the discoloration that was previously experienced by those homes serviced by the North reservoir.

6. The Board has presented its demand to Sam Ashelman regarding the cutting down of trees on common land behind D-7 (erroneously mentioned as D-6 in the October Newsletter), and has agreed to accept Sam's proposal to arrange for the planting of 15 oak and maple trees of various sizes. The unseasonably warm weather we have experienced this year should enable the planting to take place soon.

7. The Board held its November meeting at the Coolfont home of Gale Connor. Five CMA families, including Sam and Martha Ashelman, met with the Board and Committee members. The January meeting will be held on 4 January at the Davis Library in Bethesda.

8. CMA has transferred the two tennis courts near the Manor House to CRI.

9. CMA and CDC have reached agreement on the access to the S section. Our independent review

(Continued on next page...)

[From the President...continued]

concluded that, although both routes were equally viable, there were long-term maintenance advantages to accessing the S section via Wintergreen Way. It was also agreed that the road should be moved away from an unstable rock face in order that construction would not cause disturbance to the rock.

10. **The Treasurer reports that there are still six members who continue to be in arrears on current assessment. Those members are urged to pay their assessment before legal action is taken.**

CMA Welcomes the following new lot owners:

Michael and Barbara Ankrum, from Blacksburg, Virginia, who bought K-1 from the Notters

John and Patricia Waters, from Ruxton, Maryland, who bought K-11 from Melvin Chatman.

Harold and Ellen Radday, from Arlington, Virginia, who bought O-2 from the Gallants.

Clarification on Boards' Budgetary Duties

At the 1991 annual meeting, there were questions about the Board's authority to amend the budget, as permitted by the By-Laws. Please note the following, from the CMA By-Laws:

It shall be the duty of the Board:

"(j) To prepare, for membership approval at the annual meeting, a budget for the next fiscal year. The budget shall indicate expected income and proposed expenditures in at least four categories - Capital, Operations, Maintenance, and Administration.

"Where the fiscal year commences prior to budget approval, the previous year's spending levels shall be the basis for the funding of continuing Operations, Maintanance, and Administration.

"(k) To manage expenditures such that overages do not exceed 10% in any category of the approved budget and 5% for the total budget - subject to the following exception:

"Expenses for the operation and maintenance of the water and sewer system or for the protection of life or property shall not be limited by the approved budget.

"A special meeting may be called to amend an approved budget."

This 1987 amendment to the By-Laws passed by a vote of 71 in favor, none opposed.

CMA Sends Wishes For Good Health, Joy, and Peace in the New Year

The Mountainside News is published quarterly by the Coolfont Muntainside Association, 21 Coolfont, Berkeley Springs, West Virginia 25411. Call or write Sarah H. Hay, 7930 Brink Road, Gaithersburg Md. 20882 ((301) 926-7007, to comment or contribute. Letters and articles are encouraged.

Lon Dring Honored Again by Montgomery County

Lon Dring, Presbyterian minister, head of Community Ministry, and longtime CMA member, has been honored again for his continued good works by Montgomery County, which has begun construction on an affordable housing project named Dring's Reach. The project, located off Rt. 29, is the first project of the non-profit Montgomery Housing Partnership (MHP), which was brought together in 1989 through Lon's efforts. The apartments will be in four three-story buildings and will include below-market rentals as well as market rentals.

Instructions for Snow Removal

1. If the home owner regularly rents his/her home through Coolfont, the driveway will be cleared by Coolfont. If this isn't happening, check at the Lodge.

2. If the home owner has special arrangements with Coolfont (e.g., conference renting only), the driveway will be cleared ONLY IF the house is being used by Coolfont at the time of the snow storm.

3. Other home owners who want their driveways cleared must contact Alice Minnamon (258-5352 on the mountainside) to make arrangements.

Board of Directors' List

It was brought to the attention of the editor that the handy clip-and-save list of CMA officers and Board members, included in the October 1991 Newsletter, was not as clear as it could have been. Whereas, all the Board members were listed on the page, they were somewhat scattered hither and yon, according to their various committee assignments. For clarification, please staple this short list to the longer one:

CMA Board of Directors: 1991-92

President:	**Jim Bradfield**	**(301) 984-9657**
Vice President:	**Harry Birnkrant**	**(301) 299-6406**
Treasurer:	**Anne-Marie Doppman**	**(301) 983-8725**
Secretary:	**Sarah Hay**	**(301) 926-7007**
At-Large:	**Pat Betts**	**(202) 333-1923**
At-Large:	**Gale Connor**	**(304) 258-3975 or (410) 825-2539**
At-Large:	**Connie Dupre**	**(202) 244-4170**